

Nothing Ear (2024)

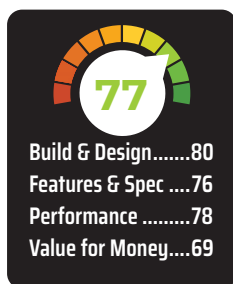
Nearly perfect

Nothing's third iteration of its truly wireless earphones is here. However, Nothing has altered its naming scheme with this version. Rather than continuing with the numerical naming convention, Nothing has chosen to simply call this one the Nothing Ear. These earbuds were launched alongside the Nothing Ear (a), a stripped-down version of the Nothing Ear, much like the (a) series of Nothing phones. The Nothing Ear introduces a few quality-of-life improvements such as longer battery life, higher-quality ceramic drivers, better call quality, and support for more high-quality codecs. On the surface, the upgrades may seem iterative rather than generational, but is that actually true? We'll find out that and more in this review. I will also compare the newly launched Nothing Ear 2024 with some of its fiercest competitors such as the OnePlus Buds Pro 2, Moto Buds+, and the OPPO Enco X2. Let's delve into my detailed Nothing Ear (2024) review.

BUILD, DESIGN, AND FIT

The Nothing Ear (2024) looks nearly identical to its predecessor, the Nothing Ear (2). The transparent case has the same design flourishes as the Nothing Ear (2), except for a couple of subtle changes. For instance, the dotted font now says 'Nothing' instead of 'Ear (case)'. It is the quintessential Nothing look we all know and love, so I'm not miffed about the minimal design changes.

The charging case is handy and functional. It can be easily flipped open one-handed and the metal hinge's construction is solid. The case is pocketable enough, but the OPPO Enco X2's diminutive case is slightly easier to stow away. Sadly, the case is as prone



to scratches as its predecessor – a couple of days of these earbuds inside my crammed backpack were enough to tarnish the case's unscathed look.

The earbuds have a fantastic fit; at 4.6 g each, they are comfortable to wear through pretty much

everything, be it an hour-long workout session or a two-hour-long work call. The buds are also IP54 dust and water-resistant, while the case sports an IP55 rating. So, wearing these buds on rainy days shouldn't be an issue.

FEATURES

The Nothing Ear (2024) sees a significant uptick in price. At ₹11,999, these are ₹2,000 more pricey than their predecessor, which will surely raise some eyebrows in the price-conscious Indian market. To that end, Nothing has fitted the Nothing Ear with pretty much every

flagship feature you would hope to find on modern-day TWS earphones.

The Nothing Ear boasts Active Noise Cancellation that claims to cut out ambient noise up to 45 dB. The earphones are also capable of intelligently adjusting the ANC levels. For example, if the device detects an inadequate in-ear fit, it bumps up the ANC levels to compensate for it. The earbuds also come with Adaptive ANC support which can automatically detect environmental noise and apply the adequate levels of ANC.

All that being said, the Active Noise Cancellation on the Nothing Ear (2024) is one of the only major misses on these earphones, in my opinion. The ANC is simply incapable of blocking out high-frequency sounds such as a moving train or a high-speed fan. The OnePlus Buds Pro 2 do a much better job at this. The Transparency Mode, on the other hand, is decent – it sounds pretty natural too.

The Nothing Ear has a fantastic supporting app. The Nothing X app is minimalist, well-designed, and easy to use. It also provides a plethora of customization options. From adjusting noise cancellation profiles to customizing controls, there's a lot you can do. You can customize every action except the single pinch one since that one is reserved for Play/Pause.

There's also EQ customization onboard in two forms – a simplistic three-band EQ for beginners and an advanced eight-band EQ for experienced users. The advanced EQ page also allows you to adjust the Q factor and gain, which is a level of customization I haven't experienced on consumer headphones so far.

There are an array of additional features such as in-ear detection, low-latency gaming mode, multipoint connectivity, Microsoft Swift Pair, wireless charging, and Google Fast Pair. The earbuds are rated IP54 dust and water-resistant while the case is rated IP55.

Another interesting feature is ChatGPT integration on the buds. When connected to a Nothing phone, the